

IA & Archives – Practical Session

1 Note your observations at each step

- Open the provided chat application.
- Select **Model A** and type in the following prompt :

*I am an archivist, working on the Georges Lemaître fonds.
Can you briefly summarize who he was ?*

- After you get an answer, **DO NOT CLEAR THE CONVERSATION**. Just change the model using the dropdown menu to select **Model B**. Ask then the following simple question, without reminding AI of the subject :

What is the date range of his work ?

- Now, switch to **Model C**, again, do not clear the conversation. Ask him now the following question :

Which works earned him his place in history?

- **Reset the conversation** (red button at the top right). Start all steps again, but **reset the conversation before each change of model**. What do you notice ?

2 Evaluate the quality of responses given by each model

For this exercise, we will compare the quality of the responses provided by the different models when given exactly the same prompt. To do this, we ask you to start by retrieving the following documents:

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_2a.png

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_2b.png

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_2c.txt

For each of these documents, you will then give the following prompt to each of the models (attaching a copy of the downloaded document).

Act as an experienced archivist. Analyze the document above. Extract: 1) The exact date, 2) The parties involved (names and roles), 3) The subject of the deed/document. Format the response in Markdown.

Compare the results obtained. Were there hallucinations? Which model respected the instructions best? Which model used the most "archival" style? **Establish your podium (ranking).**

3 Sycophancy Bias vs. "Adversarial Prompting"

Objective: Realize that the formulation of your prompt (the framing) directly and radically influences the answer given by the AI, and understand why.

Material :

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_3.md

Part A: The "Complacent" Mode

Use the following prompt to ask one of the models for a response:

I am asked to submit a draft for the funding application I am currently working on. What do you think of this one? In your opinion, do I have a chance of being accepted?

Part B: The "Critical" Mode (Adversarial)

Clear the conversation, then send the following prompt to the **same model** as before, attaching a copy of the document you downloaded again.

I am a member of a very selective funding committee; the projects we finance are extremely expensive. A casting error could easily put the whole funding organization in peril. As our budget is tight and we only fund excellence, I asked candidates to submit a first draft of the funding application they are working on so I can do a first sort without anyone wasting too much time. Analyze this file without any complacency. Don't hesitate to nitpick. Identify methodological flaws or tell me why I should reject this project. Finally, give me a general critique on this file and then issue a recommendation: (Accept, Weak Reject, Strong Reject).

Conclusions :

Compare the two responses given by the model. Also, compare the recommendation made by the same model regarding the same document. **What conclusions do you draw? How do you explain this phenomenon?**

4 Create a webpage from an EAC-XML file

Start by downloading the resources necessary to complete the exercise:

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_4a.png

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_4b.eac.xml

In this exercise, you are asked to manage to create a complete, functional webpage that respects the graphic style of another site using an EAC-XML document. **How did you proceed? How did you visualize the result of your work?**

5 Change of Scale (Scaling Up)

The objective of this question is the same as in Exercise 4. However, you must approach the problem as if you were going to be asked to produce hundreds of webpages of the same style from different EAC-XML files (though respecting the same structure). **How do you proceed?**

To validate your work, you are invited to download the following file and ensure that you have managed to produce a webpage for each of the files contained in the archive:

https://github.com/xgillard/lhist2532/raw/refs/heads/main/resources/exercice_5.zip

6 Web Scraping

In this exercise, we complicate things a little more: you are asked to do some **scraping** (foraging, harvesting) in order to retrieve the images and transcriptions of the documents available here

<https://www.oldbaileyonline.org/record/16770425>

Based on these documents, you will create an HTML webpage each time that includes the text and the image you have retrieved. (The most adventurous among you can then try to modify their approach so that it allows retrieving the images+texts of the documents listed on the next three pages.)

Finally, you will complete your approach to ensure that, in addition to the webpages linked to each of the automatically downloaded documents, your approach is capable of generating a **pre-filled EAD file canvas**.